

A HOTWIFE'S LOVE LETTER

ULTIMATE **HOTWIFE** VALENTINE



PAUL GARLAND

Paul Garland

A Hotwife's Love Letter

A Sexy Hotwife Mystery

First edition

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Foreword

This is something different for you! I was inspired by a cosy mystery novel that I wrote under a different pen name during NaNoWriMo (an author thing, Google it) to have some fun and write a mystery/hotwife/cuckold story... and here it is!

While creating this book, I fell in love with the couple (Lacey and Marcus) so much that you'll be seeing them again in the not-too-distant future but more information on that in the afterword.

A Hotwife's Love Letter is a slow-burning short story with a wildly hot sex scene that I'm hopeful you'll all go crazy about towards the end but it's also part of the [Ultimate Hotwife Valentine](#) series, a multi-author collaboration, much like the [Ultimate Hotwife Christmas](#) set that I was a part of in December. If you enjoy this book, you should go back and check out [A Hotwife's Christmas Roast](#) and the rest of both series. They're full of awesome stories from some of the best hotwife authors in the business!

Ultimate Hotwife Valentine

ULTIMATE HOTWIFE VALENTINE

Sometimes it takes more than two to tango.

This multi-author series explores the lives of women who fulfill their dirtiest fantasies with more than just their husband.

Get in the mood and fall head over heels with these naughty hotwives and the men who love them.

Read the entire series [HERE](#)

1

9.00 AM

“It can’t be morning already,” I groaned, flailing wildly with my left hand for the alarm clock. Finding it, I fumbled for the button with half-numb fingers and found it, pressing it so hard that the digital clock tumbled to the floor with a thump.

“Fuck.” I pushed myself to a sitting position and looked at it. The plastic back had popped off and the two batteries were rolling across the wooden floor of our bedroom. It was only then that I realised that Marcus wasn’t in bed with me. His side of the bed was tucked in, the pillows puffed up and straightened. Where was he?

Marcus was my long-term partner. In fact, we’d been together ten years as of a week ago today. To celebrate, he’d taken me to a lovely restaurant in Sheffield, the closest large city to the small Derbyshire village where we lived, but this morning he wasn’t here. He didn’t usually get up before me, so I was puzzled at his whereabouts.

I stretched, feeling my muscles loosen and as the fuzziness of sleep cleared from my mind, I realised what day it was and I flopped back down into bed.

“It’s Valentine’s Day,” I said out loud to no one. That might explain it. Marcus was a romantic. He always did something special for me. I guessed that his early rise this morning was a surprise of some sort. He might be

downstairs, cooking a special breakfast or something, although no smell of toast or coffee was evident to support that theory.

We'd had sex last night, something of a rarity of late, not because we didn't want to - we did, especially me, I was always horny. Marcus called me his little nympho - but rather because we'd both been so busy. He was an insurance broker, a successful one and he'd been busy expanding his business which led to him working late until he could find some suitable employees to take the workload from him. Between his long hours in the office and my volunteering work for a local women's charity, there hadn't been a lot of time for us to spend together. And when we did have time together, we'd both been tired.

"Come on, Lacey. Get your lazy ass out of bed." That's what he'd say if he saw me lying in bed, starfished underneath the covers as I was. I closed my eyes and imagined throwing the covers back, enjoying his eyes as they roamed across my naked breasts and over my belly to the small triangle of reddish hair between my thighs. I fantasized about my gorgeous, tall, hunky boyfriend getting back in bed with me, wrapping me in his muscular arms and-

A loud, skittering noise startled me from my daydream and I sat up again, wondering what the sound was until I saw our British Blue cat, Agatha, playing with one of the loose batteries.

"Agatha. You scared me," I berated her, then after she became bored of the shiny metal cylinder and wandered out of the room, leaving me alone once more, I reached down from the bed and collected the two batteries.

"Hmmmmmm." An idea crossed my mind.

I rolled onto my front and floundered under the bed with one hand, looking for the new sex toy I'd bought the other day. Unfortunately, I'd not

been able to test it because of a lack of batteries, but now...

Finding it, a seven-inch, purple rabbit-type vibrator that curved up on the end to stimulate the g-spot, I slid back the cover and inserted the batteries. Then after pressing the 'On' button to test it - it buzzed pleasantly in my hand - I kicked off the bedsheets and lay back on the bed one more time.

"Marcus?" I called out. "Marcus? Can you come here a minute? I want to show you something."

My pussy was still sticky with his cum, so the curved end of the vibe slid inside easily and I manoeuvred it so that the rubber 'ears' of the toy pressed against my clitoris, bringing a sensation that made my toes curl for a second.

"Marcus?" I shouted louder. Where was he? I wanted him to walk in and catch me masturbating. This was typical me; typical horny Lacey. The more sex I got, the more I wanted. I had a high sex drive, much higher than Marcus's but perhaps that was because I was still in my late twenties whereas he was almost a dozen years older than me at forty. He didn't look forty. He still had a head full of short black hair and his smooth skin and face barely showed any signs of middle age. Marcus kept himself fit. Gym three times a week and a (boringly) healthy diet obviously did well for him.

I grabbed my breast with my spare hand, squeezing it firmly while I began to work the toy around in little circles. The feeling of the vibrator inside me, pushing deep as I slid more in while maintaining the fluttering ears on my clit, was exquisite. I wished it was a real cock, but seeing as Marcus was either deaf or not in the house, the toy would have to do.

I could imagine it was a real cock inside me. Not Marcus's - his wasn't anywhere near as big as the rubber shaft pushing against my g-spot. Instead,

I imagined it was one of his friends, Sam, his hunky, muscular personal trainer from the gym. Sam wasn't as tall as Marcus, but he was wider. His shoulders... Mmmmm.... Just thinking about them was almost enough to make me cum. I wondered what his cock was like. Hopefully, his training regime wasn't small-dick energy manifesting itself. No... it couldn't be. There was no way a guy as hot as Sam would have a small penis. I'd seen the bulge in his grey sweatpants a few weeks ago when he'd come over for drinks with Marcus and it didn't look small.

Marcus knew I fancied Sam. I'd told him a few times, hoping that he might say something back - like that Sam fancied me too - but nothing. I was sure he did. I'd seen him eyeing me up enough times over the years. All of Marcus's friends looked at me, usually at my curvy hips (I wasn't as fit as Marcus) and my breasts. It was fun to wear low-cut tops when they were around, especially Sam or Brad, Marcus's other hot friend and cousin. In fact, all of his friends were hot, something that made me sigh loudly and spread my thighs a little wider. Sam, Brad, James, Ryan, Patrick, Leon, Philip, and Stuart, they were all sexy guys. Even Marcus's brother, Matty and his father Charles were sexy. It was almost as though my boyfriend only hung out with gorgeous studs.

I continued to imagine Sam though, his powerful arms lifting my legs and putting them up onto his shoulders while he shoved his long, thick cock inside me. Wow. Marcus might know that I thought his friends were cute, but if he knew the dirty fantasies I sometimes had, he'd be shocked.

I felt my orgasm grow close and punched my nipple between my fingers, squeezing it hard while ramming the vibrator inside hard, pushing the pulsating rabbit ears against my clit firmly.

“Ohhhhh, fuck,” I moaned as it hit me, imagining Sam’s cock exploding inside my pussy, filling me with his cum. My thighs quivered as ecstasy surged through me for a moment, and then I let the vibrator fall onto the bed and took a moment to get my breath back.

The orgasm had been dizzyingly powerful and it took a moment for me to regain my senses and finally drag myself from the bed. I wrapped a dressing gown around my nudity and studied the feline creature staring at me from the doorway.

“I hope you didn’t see that just now,” I said to Agatha, following her as she turned tail and walked down the stairs into the kitchen.

Miaow. She nosed at her empty food bowl.

“I guess you want feeding.” Marcus must have forgotten to fill her food up when he left because there was no sign of him anywhere; the house was silent.

As I opened a tin of cat food, I noted a red envelope on the kitchen counter, and with it, a pink aromatic candle, a small teddy bear and a single red rose.

“Awwww,” I said to the cat. “Look! Daddy got me a gift.”

The pink fluffy bear was cute. Its nose twinkled in the bright sunlight flooding through the kitchen blinds, clear glass cut like a shiny diamond. The rose was beautiful too, its stem wrapped in fine paper to cover the thorns and the flower itself was a brilliant red, the petals just beginning to open. The candle smelled of passion fruit.

“Very romantic,” I murmured, smiling happily to myself, then I slipped a fingernail beneath the flap of the scarlet envelope and pulled out the card. On the front was a pink love heart, with the message ‘Be My Valentine’ and I opened it, spotting Marcus’s familiar writing inside.

I love you, his flowing handwriting read. Happy Valentine's Day. Last night was fun, so I'm sorry that I had to head out early this morning but I have an important meeting. Bear with me though, I have something amazing planned for you tonight. Give me a call when you have a minute.

"He's so sweet," I told Agatha as she finished licking the bowl clean. She must have been hungry. I felt momentarily guilty that I'd kept her waiting while I got myself off then looked around for my phone to call my lovely and romantic man.

Where was it? It took me a second to realise that I hadn't brought it downstairs with me, but even when I headed upstairs, I couldn't find it. It wasn't on the dressing table or the bedside cabinet. What the hell had I done with it? I tried to recall last night's events, retracing my steps from the living room to the bedroom but nothing helped. It was nowhere to be found, so I tried calling it from the landline phone. Even then, nothing. I couldn't hear it ringing. Had I left it on vibrate? Fuck.

After wandering around the house for a while longer, I returned to the phone and called Marcus. Fortunately, I knew his number off the top of my head, one of the few numbers I had memorized along with my parents.

"Hey baby," I said when he picked up. "Thank you for the gifts and the card. And the sex."

I giggled, waiting for him to reply but the other end of the phone was silent for a long moment.

"Lacey," he said, after what felt like an age. "This is going to sound weird but listen carefully. The meeting I had this morning... I've been tricked."

"What?" I frowned. This wasn't like Marcus. He didn't sound right. "Tricked how?"

“I’ve booked us a special meal tonight,” he continued, his voice still sounding odd. “At The Purple Ivy.”

“The Purple Ivy?” I gasped, the strangeness of his tone forgotten for a moment. “No way. That’s the most exclusive place... You’re joking. I mean, there’s like, a six-month waiting list for a table unless you’re a V.I.P.”

“We’re V.I.P. for tonight,” he explained, his voice lifting for a moment. “But this meeting, when I got here, there was a guy in a balaclava.”

“Oh... what?” A touch of fear slid across my skin.

“I’m not in danger,” Marcus continued. “It’s some sort of prank. A Valentine’s prank. He blindfolded me and took me to a hotel room - I don’t know where I am. I’m locked in but before he left, he gave me a message to pass on to you. I tried calling you but he’s done something to my phone. I can’t make outgoing calls.”

“My phone is missing,” I interrupted. “Wait-”

“I know. He’s got it. I don’t know how. I presume he sneaked into the house after I’d left.”

“Marcus, this is terrifying.”

“I know but stay calm. As I said, we’re not in danger. It’s a prank. You see, the message he told me to give to you was this: on the doormat, if you haven’t found them already, there should be a pile of Valentine’s Day cards. You’re to open them, starting with the smallest and working to the largest and figure out who they’re from.”

“Stay calm?” My hands were shaking. “Marcus, how can I stay calm? This is a matter for the police. You’ve been abducted.”

“Lacey, listen to me. The guy who... abducted me, as you put it... It’s one of my friends. I know it is. He said I know him but he had some sort of voice changer so I couldn’t recognise his voice. He sounded familiar, but

the voice changer thing... Anyway, he told me this is just a bit of fun and that he'll let me out soon but if I want to be free in time for the Purple Ivy reservation, you have to work out the clues in the cards."

"You're joking," I complained. "This is a prank? Really? Oh, boy. When I figure out which one of your idiot friends decided to pull this stunt... I'm going to rip them a new asshole."

"You know what they're like," Marcus laughed, but his laugh still didn't sound right. He wasn't relaxed. There was more to this than met the eye. I knew there was. "Plus, they know you've always had this thing about mysteries and that you fancy yourself as an amateur sleuth."

He was right on both counts. Marcus and his friends were always pulling stupid pranks on each other. Recently, Marcus tied his friend James to a bridge over the motorway - totally naked - on his stag night. And that was one of the tamer jokes. It was also true that I loved detective books. I'd even named my cat after Agatha Christie.

"Okay. What time is the reservation? How long do I have?" I sighed, resigning myself to the fact that we had to play along with their little game. "I'm going to put the phone down and see if these cards are on the doormat. Then I'll call you back."

"Great. Seven o'clock," Marcus replied, "But my phone is almost dead. The battery is on one percent. So, if I don't answer, that's why. Hurry up, Lacey. If we miss this reservation, it'll take me months to get another one."

The phone went dead before he even had a chance to say goodbye. I tried calling him back but the call didn't connect.

"Fuck." Agatha looked up at the sharpness of my voice but I wasn't going to apologise to a cat. I wandered into the hallway and as promised,

there was a small pile of cards on the mat. I picked them up, four in total, each one a different size.

“Smallest to largest,” I reminded myself, then opened the first one.

2

10.05 AM

My hands were trembling - even though I knew it was a game - as I tore open the smallest envelope, a plain white paper one, and slid out a card strangely adorned with a cute Dr Zeuss character on the front, a fuzzy creature with a red hat and some weird suggestive message about breakfast eggs and preferring them fertilized or unfertilized.

Opening it up, I was met with the usual printed Valentine's poem but I was more interested in the unfamiliar handwriting below it.

Roses are red, of that there's no doubt. Who I am shouldn't be hard to workout.

What? That was it? I turned the card over in my hand a couple of times. Nothing. I re-read it.

Roses are red, of that there's no doubt. Who I am shouldn't be hard to workout.

How was I meant to make anything from that? Perhaps I'd heard him wrong. Maybe I'd opened the wrong card first. Measuring the envelopes in my hand, I opened the largest. This envelope was black and the card within

it was black too but covered in sparkling love hearts. The message was from a different hand but was equally short and cryptic.

Roses are red, love is forever. Our blood is not shared, but our hearts sing together.

“You’re fucking kidding me,” I cursed, which was again met by a disapproving stare from Agatha’s large blue eyes. I opened one of the two medium-sized cards, the first in a red envelope, and pulled out the cutesy card inside.

Roses are red, violets are too. If you can figure this out, all credit to you.

Again, impossible. Was I really supposed to be able to figure out who these were from? The last card was in a grey envelope and contained a plain card which had ink smeared on the front.

“Yuck,” I said, wiping my hand on my dressing gown before opening it up and reading the final message.

Roses are red, but they don’t grow in this park. A day of romance can repair any heart.

“Well, Agatha,” I said, shrugging and then tossing the cards on the floor in front of her in frustration. “I think there’s about as much chance of you solving this mystery as me.”

Miaow, replied my cat predictably.

The last message I’d read sounded the strangest and might be the easiest to work out but my mind went back to what Marcus had said. Smallest to

largest. There must be a clue somewhere in the smallest card that would make the others easier to work out. That was usually how these things worked, right?

I bent down and retrieved the envelopes, checking to make sure that there wasn't anything inside them or even written inside. Nope. I took the cards into the kitchen and made a hot drink then sat down to concentrate. I was intelligent. I could do this.

"Roses are red, of that there's no doubt. Who I am shouldn't be hard to work out," I read out loud, once I'd sat down and taken a sip of my strong, black coffee. "Think, Lacey Hawke. Think. You can work this out."

Wait.

Work this out.

I read the message again. "Who I am shouldn't be hard to work out," I murmured. "But it doesn't say *work out*. It says *workout*."

Then something else clicked into place. The fuzzy creature on the front... the reference to eggs... It wasn't just eggs. It said *green eggs*. As in Green Eggs and Ham.

"Green eggs and ham," I recounted some of the rhyme from memory. "I do not like them, Sam I am."

Sam I am.

Sam was a personal trainer. He worked at the gym. *Workout*, the misspelt word.

"Where do you work out?" I asked Agatha. She blinked at me and didn't miaow this time, obviously impressed with my deductive skills. "You work out at the gym! This is from Sam."

I rushed upstairs, almost tripping over my long dressing gown but skidded to a stop when I reached the bedroom. Now what? What did I do

now? I should call Sam and tell him I'd worked his little puzzle out.

Fuck.

My phone was missing and I didn't know Sam's number.

There was only one thing to do. I had to go to the gym and confront him. Perhaps that was the plan all along. I had to work out who the cards were from and then head there. Either way, it was my only option, so I quickly showered and got dressed, once I'd cleaned the vibrator and stashed it in the drawer with the rest of my sex toy collection.

I looked at myself in the mirror as I fixed my hair. I looked a mess but I didn't have time to make myself look perfect. I fastened my annoyingly wavy red hair into a high ponytail and slapped on some mascara lipstick. I was wearing a plain white t-shirt and jeans but it would have to do because I was racing against the clock. The time was almost eleven o'clock. The Purple Ivy was a half-hour drive, so I had until 6.30 pm at the absolute latest to figure this out and rescue our reservation.

I headed out, having to go back into the house to retrieve my three gifts and the four Valentine's cards after I'd forgotten them so that I could confront Sam with them and then got into the car and made my way to the gym.

As I drove, question after question popped into my head. What if he wasn't there? I'd been to his house once or twice with Marcus but I couldn't remember where it was exactly. If he was there, what the hell did I say to him? What if I was wrong?

I couldn't be wrong. The clues were clear. It had to be him. Or did it? I'd been fantasizing about him this morning while masturbating, so had he sprung to mind prematurely? Was I jumping to conclusions?

“Here we are,” I muttered to myself as I pulled up outside the gym, a small, glass-fronted building on the edge of the village. “Here goes nothing.”

As I stepped out of the car, my heart sank. A sign on the door read, ‘Closed,’ and as my eyes hurriedly searched out the opening times on the wall, my heart sank.

“Fuck my life,” I cursed. The gym didn’t open until lunch on Tuesdays and today was Tuesday, the fourteenth of February was a fucking Tuesday. This couldn’t be right. I must have missed something.

“You worked it out.”

The trainer’s familiar smooth voice made me jump and I spun around angrily.

“Sam! You little...”

“Calm down,” the muscular friend of Marcus raised his arms in surrender. “Let’s go inside and talk, shall we?”

“Oh, yeah,” I nodded and narrowed my eyes at him. “We’ve got lots to talk about. You’ve got some explaining to do.”

“This isn’t me,” Sam argued as he unlocked the doors and ushered me inside before locking them back up again. “You’re probably not going to believe this, but a guy in a balaclava - one of Marcus’s friends, but I don’t know who - made me write a message in a card and then he-”

“Wait,” I said, following him through the gym into a small canteen at the back. “So you’re saying you’re not behind all this?”

“Absolutely not,” the broad man replied. “Sit down. Have a drink.”

I did as he suggested because my knees had suddenly gone weak. I’d thought this was the end of it. I thought I’d solved it.

“Yesterday, this guy approached me as I locked up. At first, I was scared but then I realised what it was - one of Marcus’s pranks, no doubt. Anyway, he recited a rhyme, something about working out, the roses are red thing... then he said I had to hang around at the gym this morning for you to turn up.”

“Right. That’s it?” I said, taking the energy drink he passed me as he sat down opposite me at the small canteen table.

Sam was gorgeous. Even now, in a heightened state of anxiety, like I was, I couldn’t help but stare at him. He was ripped and in the tight black vest he was wearing, I could see the shape of his pecs; his shoulders; his abs.

“Well, there’s more, I guess.” He rubbed a hand through his curly dark brown hair and his pretty green eyes held mine for a moment. “There’s this too.”

“What’s this?” I said, accepting another envelope from him as he slid it across the table.

“Man. This is so cringe,” he replied, giving me a slight shrug and then standing up and pacing around the table. “Just open it.”

He was wearing his grey sweatpants again and I could see his bulge move as he paced up and down while waiting for me to read the handwritten letter that I pulled from the envelope.

Hi Lacey, it started and then my eyes widened as I read the rest of it.

Congratulations on finding your first love letter. I knew you could do it.

This is Sam. He’s one of Marcus’s oldest friends, in fact, I think you knew him before you even met Marcus.

I know you fancy Sam. You told Marcus as much, didn't you? Marcus has seen you stare at him. We all have. We've even seen you look at his dick when he wears his gym gear. You want to see it, don't you? I asked him to wear his grey sweats today. Is he wearing them? Why don't you ask to see his dick? He'll show you, if you ask because he fancies you too, Lacey. He always has. Why don't you ask him about his secret?

Once you're done here, you need to work out your next clue. Once you've worked them all out, you'll have the code to unlock the door of the hotel room where Marcus is trapped.

Good luck.

"Jeez. This is embarrassing," Sam said, hitching up the waistband of his sweatpants as he finished watching me read.

"You know what it says in here?" I asked. "You've read it already?"

"Of course I have," he shrugged, drawing my eyes to his muscular chest again for a moment.

I didn't know what to say. I suddenly became acutely aware that my cheeks were glowing.

"Don't be embarrassed," the trainer said, walking around the table and sitting on the table next to me. "I know you fancy me. It's cool. We're friends, right?"

"I'm not embarrassed," I lied. "I just feel... awkward. Let's not talk about all that stuff, please. Just tell me what happens next. You know, right?"

"Yeah," Sam nodded then took a deep breath, expanding his broad chest for a moment. "Lacey, look. I've always fancied you, since we were

teenagers, back at school. I wanted to ask you out but I was shy back then and Marcus got there first.”

I stared at him, unsure of how to reply to that.

“That’s what he means by *my secret*,” Sam added. “You must know that even now... I’d love to-”

“You’d love to... what?”

“You know?”

“I don’t,” I shook my head. “Say it. Is it something to do with this code?”

“No. Are you going to make me say it?”

“Just spit it out, Sam.”

“Fine. I’d love to fuck you.” The trainer stood up again and paced around the table, avoiding eye contact now.

“Well, duh,” I giggled, despite the awkwardness that was growing by the second. I was flattered. “I’ve seen you stare at my tits and ass enough times to know that.”

“It’s that obvious, huh?” Sam smiled and the tension in the room finally dissipated. Then he looked down at the bunch of cards in my lap that I’d almost forgotten about. “What are those?”

“You’re not the only one of Marcus’s friends to send me a card and a cryptic message.” I leafed through the cards, then tossed them on the table for him to look at.

“Huh?”

As Sam picked up the other three cards that weren’t his, I told him the entire story of my day so far; how Marcus hadn’t been in bed when I’d woken up; my phone call to him after I’d found his gifts and opened his

card and how that had sent me on this crazy quest once I'd worked out the first clue that led me here.

"You know, it sounds like something Leon might do," Sam stroked his chin, reading the messages in the cards and shaking his head. "He's cleverer than you might think."

"Leon, the mechanic?" I asked doubtfully, looking out through the windows at the street outside. It would be noon before long. "Really?"

"Absolutely. And he loves this whole riddle thing. His garage is full of crosswords."

"Who else?" I asked, still looking out of the window to try and distract myself from looking at Sam's groin. The way he was sitting made his bulge more prominent.

"Hmmm. James... no, it's not him. James wouldn't have the brains to do something like this. This is devious. I can't see Stuart doing it. He's way too busy. Patrick is the same and I know Matty wouldn't do something like this to his brother. That would be weird. And Ryan's such an accounts nerd that he'd make the riddles all sums and figures or algebra questions. As for Brad? No. He's Marcus's cousin, plus he's much more straightforward like singers always are and-"

"Wait." Something Sam had just said made me pause. Sums... figures... That was it.

"What?" Sam's long-lashed green eyes gazed into mine, making me blush involuntarily.

"Where's the card?" I fished through them until I found the one I wanted, the cutesy one and the second smallest. I read out the message inside, written in the clearest and simplest handwriting. "Roses are red,

violets are too. If you can figure this out, all credit to you. *Figures. Credit.* This is Ryan. It has to be.”

“I’m a genius,” chuckled Sam, then flexed an impressive bicep right in front of my face, so close that I wanted to reach out and squeeze it. “Brawn *and* brains. Who’d have known?”

“I need to leave,” I said, taking a long drink from the bottle before slamming it down on the tabletop. “Ryan’s accountancy office is right around the corner, right?”

“It sure is,” Sam replied, standing up and adjusting his sweatpants so that his bulge finally disappeared from view. “Before you go. You need the code. You didn’t ask.”

“Oh, yeah,” I smiled. “What is it?”

“Nine,” he replied, smiling back. “The first number is nine. That’s all I know. Also... there’s the other thing you didn’t ask.”

His smile grew wider and I knew what he was talking about. The question the letter had suggested I ask.

“I’m not going to ask to see your cock,” I laughed. “Although it’s tempting.”

“Are you sure?” he asked, his voice suddenly sounding huskier and his smile slipping.

“Sam... I have to go.” Why wasn’t I leaving? I’d stood up but I was hesitating, gazing out of the window again.

“Marcus once said something,” the trainer said, slowly walking around the table to stand in front of me. “He said you’d been curious, that you’d asked him if he’d ever seen me naked, in the showers for instance.”

“I was drunk,” I said, my voice tight. I felt a light sweat break out across my forehead. Was it hot in here or something? “I have to go.”

My legs came back under my control and I walked out into the gym and towards the door until Sam jogged after me and caught me by the hand.

“I meant what I said,” he said softly, making my heart thump in my chest. He was so close to me. I could smell his cologne. “I like you. I always have. I know you’re in love with Marcus and that’s cool but... Well, I just wanted you to know.”

“Show me,” I said, my control slipping. “You’re right, I’m curious. Show me your dick.”

I expected Sam to grin in satisfaction at breaking my resolve but he didn’t. In fact, he looked slightly nervous as he pulled down his sweatpants and shorts to reveal a cock that made me catch my breath. His pubic hair was trimmed short, almost shaved but he didn’t need that to make him look bigger. He was long and thick and beginning to stiffen as I gazed at it.

“Fuck,” I moaned softly, fighting the impulse to take hold of it; to put it in my mouth and bring it to full hardness. Then the urgency of my situation hit me, snapping me out of the almost hypnotic trance I found myself in. “Sam, I have to go. I’m racing against the clock.”

“Sure,” he said, his voice thick with undisguised disappointment. “Maybe we can continue this conversation another day?”

“Maybe,” I said, glancing through the windows and hoping no one had seen the two of us like that. “Thanks for the help, Sam.”

The trainer unlocked the door and I ran to my car as fast as I could before my resolve caved in once more.

3

11.58 AM

“Can I help you?”

I was so busy gazing around at the plush office reception that I almost didn't notice the pretty petite blonde sitting behind a desk in the corner.

“I'm looking for Ryan Porter?”

“Mr Porter Senior or Junior?” the blonde fixed a smile on her face so insipid and fake that I briefly felt the urge to slap her. I'd forgotten that Ryan ran his accountancy business jointly with his father. “Junior. Is he in? It's rather urgent.”

“And you are?”

Urgh. She was so slappable that I could almost feel my hand twitching. I kept it pressed to my side. “Lacey Hawke. I'm a friend. It's a personal thing.”

“Hmm.” She had the audacity to look me up and down. “I'll put a call through to his office.”

“Don't bother.” Ryan's voice made her almost drop the phone in surprise.

“Mr Porter,” she said, gathering herself and fluttering her eyelashes at him. So that was it. This tart had designs on Ryan, did she? “I was just-”

“It’s fine. I’ll see Miss Hawke in my office.” Ryan beamed at me. When he smiled, it was easy to see why the receptionist was so taken with him; why *so many* women were taken with him. He was handsome. Just like Marcus, he was tall, but unlike my boyfriend, Ryan was blonde, his hair immaculately styled, a hint of darker stubble grazing his square jaw. Crystalline blue eyes considered me from beneath his strong brow. “This way.”

I followed the stylishly suited Ryan into his office and he closed the door behind him then pointed to the leather settee next to his huge walnut desk. He didn’t have to tell me to sit down. There was something about Ryan that made you just know what he wanted.

“I’m sorry to bother you-” I began but he silenced me with a look and then reached into a drawer in his desk.

“I have something for you. This is why you’re here. I know about the game, so I hope this helps you win.”

Win? That was a word I hadn’t heard used yet. Interesting.

“Thank you.” I took the letter that he passed to me. “This is the second letter I’ve received today.”

“Who did the first clue point you towards?” Marcus’s accountant asked me, all seriousness as he perched himself on the edge of his desk to watch me read the note.

“Sam,” I puffed out my cheeks, then exhaled loudly. “Ryan, I don’t have a lot of time to talk. Do you have a code number for me? I can read the letter later. I need to figure out the next clue.”

“I understand.” He gazed at me, his eyes softening. “Let me help you. What time is your reservation?”

“Seven o’clock. It’s noon now, so I need to- Hold on, how do you know about the reservation and this... game?”

Ryan laughed, his voice rich and deep. “When the stranger asked me to play along this morning, I refused until he explained everything. I don’t know who he is, Lacey, but I have to admit, he’s a genius.”

Genius? That was a word that Sam had just used. Had Ryan been listening in somehow?

“He told you this morning?” I asked, frowning. He saw Sam last night. Was this important?

“He was waiting outside the office door as I got here,” Ryan nodded. “And to answer your request, yes, I have a code number for you but the stranger made it very clear that you had to read my letter first.”

“Your letter? Did you write it?”

“He told me it was part of the game. His Valentine’s Day prank, as he called it.”

Prank. Game. Genius. Ryan was full of interesting words. I was starting to lean towards him being behind this entire thing. He certainly had the brains for it.

“Fine. I’ll read it, I just hope it’s not as embarrassing as Sam’s was.”

I unfolded the letter and stared dumbfounded at the words that met my eyes.

Dear Lacey,

I’ll get straight to the point. You know me. I prefer numbers to words, so I’ll keep this brief.

The stranger told me to tell you how I feel about you. He said it’s all part of the game, so here it is.

Marcus is the luckiest man on Earth. You're incredibly sexy. How and why you're with Marcus I don't know. He's my friend, my oldest friend, and I love him, but if I could have one night in bed with you, I wouldn't hesitate.

Oh, he knows this. If I've told him once, I've told him a thousand times. He knows that I'd love to bed you. I've begged him to show me any nudes he has of you. I've asked him if you'd ever do a threesome with me and him or I could have you for a night to myself. He always says no. And I know why. He's afraid that I'd steal you from him.

I probably would. You're incredible.

“Really?” I said, when I eventually found my voice. Today was turning out to be an eye-opener all right. “You really said those things to him?”

“Why would I lie?” Ryan shrugged, not fazed in the least by the revelations staring up at me from the sheet of paper in my hands.

“You asked him for a threesome with me?” I couldn't believe this. Ryan had never once so much as flirted with me. “And you wanted nudes?”

“He never showed me any,” the accountant smiled ruefully. “Marcus is a good guy. You're lucky to have him.”

For the second time today, I felt myself blush. “Okay... well, can I have the code now?”

“If you so much as gave me the chance to fuck you,” Ryan's blue eyes focused on mine, “I'd take it in a heartbeat, Lacey. I've never wanted anyone so much in my entire life.”

“Ryan, stop.” I took a deep breath, trying to calm the uncomfortable heat growing between my legs. I'd just seen Sam's huge dick and now Ryan

was turning me on in a totally different way. I needed to get out of here before I lost my composure again.

“I won’t stop,” he said softly, his voice melting me further. “But okay. The code is six. Oh, and he said to tell you that you already have a map to the hotel. You might not know it, but you do.”

“What?” This was new.

“That’s all he said. Now pass me the cards. Let’s see if we can work out the next one.”

With a hand that was still shaking slightly from Ryan’s passionate words a moment ago, I handed him the two cards that still needed solving. He read them and shrugged.

“They’re not easy, are they?”

“Nope and this one has some sort of slime on it.” I noticed he’d got some of the black ink on his hand from the back of the other medium-sized card.

“Ink, I think,” I told him, feeling bad when I saw the look of distaste on his face. It was lucky that he hadn’t gotten it on his crisp white shirt sleeve or he’d have probably made me pay for his dry cleaning.

“Not ink,” he corrected, sniffing at the dark smear on his fingers before wiping them clean on a piece of paper towel from his desk. “Oil.”

“Oil?” I frowned. “Are you sure? Because-”

“Leon,” Ryan nodded. “Read the clue. Roses are red, but they don’t grow in this park. A day of romance can *repair* any heart. He even highlighted the word repair.”

My pulse quickened with excitement. “A park that flowers don’t grow in... A car park. And repair... He’s a mechanic. Leon is next. Sam even said

that he thought Leon might be behind this. He's the prankster of your group, he says."

"After Marcus himself, yes, Leon is the joker of the pack." Ryan stood up and smoothed down the front of his trousers in a way that drew my eyes to his bulge and I had to snatch them away before he saw me looking. "I'll show you out. Time is moving on."

"Thank you," I said, standing up and walking towards the office door but again, I was stopped by a hand grabbing mine.

"A kiss?" Ryan asked, pulling me close. "Just one kiss. As thanks."

I tried to say something but no words came. His face drew close. His breath smelled like mint. His eyes were so very blue. His lips met mine and I didn't resist, kissing him back with total abandon. I'd always thought Ryan was gorgeous and along with Sam, I'd fantasized about sex with him more times than I cared to admit, but he was an even better kiss than I'd ever dreamed of.

"I need to go," I said breathlessly before I did something I'd regret later, like letting him fuck me over his huge walnut desk. Was his dick as big as Sam's?

"Of course," he said, taking a step back and opening the door for me. "Thank you for the kiss and good luck with Leon."

I almost didn't want to leave but I had to. The clock on the wall behind Ryan said 12.30pm and Leon's garage was on the other side of the village.

"I'll see you soon," I managed to stammer.

"I hope so." He smiled and I fled before my knees gave way, rushing past the bemused receptionist and into my car, where I took a moment to gather myself.

“Pull yourself together, Lacey,” I said, fixing my hair in the rearview mirror before starting the engine and heading towards the garage. “That’s twice you’ve nearly fucked up today. Let’s try to avoid doing the same with Leon and whoever mystery man number four is.”

The problem was that Leon was every bit as sexy as Sam and Ryan and if the last two encounters were anything to go by, there was every chance I was going to fuck up. But I didn’t have a choice. Marcus needed my help. We had a reservation at the most exclusive restaurant in the area and I was determined to make it. No matter what.

4

1.30 PM

“**Y**ou’re later than I expected.” Leon was waiting for me outside his humble little garage on the outskirts of town.

“So I’m right about you being the next clue. I didn’t plan on there being roadworks all the way here. The traffic was terrible.” I looked back at my car as I walked over to him. “You know, if I had more time, I’d leave my car here for you to look at. It’s been making a weird noise all day like something is rattling in the back.”

“I’ll take a look tomorrow if you like.” Leon flashed a smile at me, his teeth white against his dark brown skin. “Come in. I have something for you.”

I followed the slim, black mechanic past the two cars he was working on, one of which was on stilts with several wires hanging down while the other had the engine totally removed from the open bonnet. When we reached the back of the garage, he reached across a greasy worktop and retrieved a letter.

“Another love letter,” I sighed, taking it from him. “Are you declaring your undying love for me in this one too, like Sam and Ryan so far?”

“Really?” Leon said, looking confused. “I’m sorry but I don’t know much about this. A guy dropped into the garage last night. Balaclava, voice changer. Scared the shit out of me. I thought he was going to rob me.”

“He did the same with the others,” I nodded, watching as Leon undid the zip that fastened the front of his dirty blue overalls. He peeled it off, revealing his black, muscular torso for a moment until he pulled his shirt back down.

“Sorry,” he apologised. “I feel a bit greasy and dirty talking to you in my work clothes.”

“It’s fine,” I assured him, then related the story of my day so far, explaining everything like I’d needed to with Sam, if not Ryan.

“That’s freaky,” Leon sat, relaxing against the work counter, next to a gleaming Harley Davidson bike that I hadn’t noticed before. “He explained that it was a game but I thought you were in on it. I didn’t know it was all a big surprise like this. Well, if you’re in a rush, I guess you better read my letter.”

Oh, crap. Was this going to be as difficult as the last two?

Hey Lacey,

Balaclava guy told me I had to tell you this, so I hope it doesn’t embarrass or offend you. I’ve known you for a long time and I don’t think it will, but if I do, I’m sorry. It’s all part of the game, the guy said, so I’m going along with it.

A couple of years ago, we were playing Squash, Marcus and me and in the showers afterwards, he casually mentioned to me that you'd asked if the rumours about black guys are true.

I paused and put the letter down for a moment. This was excruciating. It was true. I had asked Marcus that and he'd told me that in Leon's case at least, yes, it was true. He had a big cock.

"Are you okay?" Leon asked gently. "Did you read it all?"

I shook my head, unable to talk from embarrassment, then picked the note back up and read on.

He told me that he'd told you about the size of my cock and then he said that you'd confessed to always wanting to sleep with a black man and how it was one of your regrets that you'd never tried black cock.

God, this was torture. Leon knew about that conversation. He knew!

He told the rest of the guys too, one night in the pub when we'd all had too much to drink. I'll be honest with you, Lacey, the guys all got a bit horny and Marcus ended up telling them that you're a bit of a nympho and that you love sex. He even went on to say that he feels bad because he can't keep up with you sometimes. Don't be angry with Marcus. He's a great guy and more than just my squash partner. He's one of my best friends in the world. He was just drunk. Drunk guys sometimes say shit. He didn't mean to embarrass you. He loves you more than anything. You should marry him. I know he's

asked you numerous times but you keep saying no. Perhaps you should rethink that. I know you'll never find a nicer guy than him.

“For what it’s worth,” Leon said when I finally put the letter down and sat down heavily on a drum of some sort behind me. “A lot of white girls are curious. It’s cool. No big deal. Don’t be embarrassed. I’m flattered that you’re interested. You’re a good-looking girl, I can’t deny that.”

Here we go again. This was all too much.

“Oh fuck,” he said after a long moment of awkward silence while I tried to think of something to say.

“What?”

“You shouldn’t have sat there.” The black man winced as I stood up and looked behind me to see a large patch of black dirt all over the bottom part of my t-shirt where I’d sat on it.

“Oh no,” I cursed. “Fuck. Look at the state of me. Today just keeps going from bad to worse.”

“Hey, it’s okay,” Leon said in a calming tone. “I have a few spare t-shirts. They might be a bit big on you but better than walking around in an oily top for the rest of your day. You certainly won’t get into the Purple Ivy looking and smelling like that.”

He disappeared into a back room for a moment, then came back with a black t-shirt that would indeed dwarf me but I didn’t have much choice. He was right. I couldn’t get in the car in this or I’d get oil all over the seat.

“Thank you,” I said, accepting it as he handed it over. “Would you mind turning around while I change?”

“Awww, man,” he complained. “So you get to ask questions about my dick-” he reached down inside his still-open overalls and grabbed his

package suggestively, “-But I can’t even ask to see your bra?”

“Wow. What has got into you guys today?” I asked. “Sam shows me his dick. Ryan goes in for a kiss. Now you want to watch me get changed.”

“Sam’s got a big dick, right?” Leon chuckled. “Trust me. Mine is bigger.”

“Aren’t you surprised?” I asked him, suddenly suspicious. “About Ryan wanting a kiss and Sam suddenly wanting to expose himself? You’re all acting weird and I’m beginning to think that you’re all in on it. Perhaps it’s not one of you. Maybe there’s no stranger in a balaclava. Maybe this is a plan the four of you came up with together.”

Leon considered me, his deep-set, dark eyes peering at me from beneath his heavy brow. He wiped his hand on a rag and then rubbed it through his short, black hair. He was handsome, in a different way to Sam and Ryan. Sam was buff, cute and well-built. Ryan was smooth and commanding and classically handsome. Leon was rough around the edges, a tall, athletic black guy with a certain presence that drew women to him. He’d had dozens of girlfriends since I’d known him and they’d almost always been drop-dead gorgeous.

“You have my word that this crazy game isn’t of my doing,” he said softly, in his deep bass voice. “This is the work of your stranger, I promise and I’m one hundred percent sure that you’ll find out who it is before this Valentine’s Day is over.”

“Really?” I asked. Leon spoke with conviction. I was certain he was telling the truth.

“I have a code number for you,” he nodded. “Five. Also, the balaclava guy told me to tell you that the map has a message but to understand it, you have to embrace the warmth of passion.”

“The warmth of passion?” I laughed at the sheer nonsense of it all. This was nuts. This entire thing was just nuts.

“He said you’d need to decipher that riddle to understand it all.” Leon shrugged. “Don’t shoot the messenger. I’m just doing as I was told.”

“Whatever,” I sighed. “I still haven’t even figured out the final card’s riddle yet.”

I passed it to him and watched him read it.

“Seems obvious to me,” he arched an eyebrow in my direction.

“Obvious? How?”

“You like the bike?” Leon changed the subject for a moment, pointing at the Harley next to him. “I just finished cleaning it up. Do you know whose it is?”

When I shook my head, wondering where he was going with all of this, he continued. “Who loves his motorbikes? Out of Marcus’s friend circle.”

“Only Brad, that I know of.” I shrugged. “What’s Brad got to do with the final clue? Oh shit, of course. Brad is Marcus’s cousin. The rhyme says we don’t share blood. I don’t share blood with him but Marcus does.”

“And then he mentions hearts singing together. Lacey, Brad is a singer in his band. This is the most obvious clue.”

“It is. I could kick myself.” He was right. It had been easy but perhaps that was the plan, to leave the easiest riddle for last so that I didn’t run out of time. Or was it just that Leon had more information than he was letting on? My suspicions as to the identity of balaclava guy were growing but I didn’t need to figure that part out yet. My next task was to find Brad, wherever he was.

“He’ll be at his studio,” Leon said, reading my mind while giving away yet more information that I wasn’t sure how he knew. “But I wouldn’t go

dressed like that.”

I realised that I still had his black t-shirt in my hand. I knew what he was hinting at. He certainly wasn't making any move to turn around.

“Fine,” I hissed and lifted my dirty top up and over my head. Too late, I remembered which bra I was wearing today, a lacy white half-cup which showed off more than I'd like, including the pale pink shape of my nipples through the gauzy material, but it was too late now. “Happy now?”

I let him look at my breasts in the bra for a moment, appreciation obvious on his smirking face as well as at his groin, where his bulge grew as I watched.

“You want to see?” Leon asked, catching me looking downwards. “You showed me yours, so I'll show you mine if you like?”

“I've already seen one cock today.” I shook my head, although yet again, I was sorely tempted to say the opposite. I pulled the t-shirt over my head, eliciting a moan of disappointment from the handsome black mechanic and then I made to leave.

“Before you go,” he called out as I made my way past the under-repair cars. “If you ever want to try a black guy, perhaps before finally marrying Marcus, please let it be me.”

“If that ever happens,” I sighed, “It won't, but if it ever did, you'd be the first in the queue, I promise.”

“That's all I needed to hear,” his deep voice called out again as I headed to the car. “Good luck, Lacey. I'll see you later.”

It wasn't until I was on my way to the studio that I realised what he'd just said.

I'll see you later.

Did that mean something, or was it just a turn of phrase? I'd figure that out later when it came time to work out the identity of the stranger. Right now, I had to confront Brad, Marcus's rocker cousin, and read whatever was in his inevitably revealing letter.

5

2.30 PM

The trip to Brad's small studio took me back in the direction of home and I briefly considered popping into the house to change out of the huge baggy t-shirt I was wearing. Brad was possibly the hottest of all of Marcus's friends and family and I didn't want him to see me looking such a mess but I simply didn't have time. It was half past two now and to rescue this situation I had to work out any final clues that Brad had for me, then head home, get changed into something appropriate for such an upmarket restaurant before even thinking about the half-hour drive to the Purple Ivy.

As I drove, I reflected on what Leon had said. It was true that Marcus had asked me to marry him, twice now, and both times I'd said no. Not an outright no, more of a 'not yet' and he'd understood. Marcus was the perfect guy for me. Handsome, kind, funny, financially secure. There was just something stopping me. I didn't feel ready.

I also realised how fucking horny I was. My panties felt damp and I wondered again if I should go home and change. First I'd spent time in close proximity to Sam and had even seen his huge cock. Then Ryan had got all smooth on me and told me he'd fantasized about fucking me for years then Leon had said more or less the same, offered to show me his dick (something I now regretted declining) and I'd let him see me in my almost see-through bra. What had gotten into everyone today, including me? I

needed a fuck. God, I hoped that Brad didn't try it on. There was every chance my last remaining shred of conviction might snap.

As soon as I got to the studio. It was housed in one of two small former shop properties on the south side of the village, the other of which was still empty, I noted as I saw Brad sitting outside with a blunt in his mouth. He waved as he saw me pull up.

"You took your time." He looked at his watch. "The guy on the phone said you'd probably be here an hour ago. He must have overestimated your riddle-solving abilities."

"Hilarious," I said, getting out of the car and closing the door behind me. "As you said, Brad, we don't have time, so shall we go inside and get this out of the way?"

"This? What does *this* entail?" He chuckled to himself, then tossed his long light brown hair over his shoulder and stood up. "And what the fuck are you wearing?"

"Long story," I sighed. "Let's just go inside and read your letter or whatever else you've got in store for me seeing as you're the last clue, or suspect, or whatever you are."

"So, yeah," the rocker that was Marcus's cousin made conversation as we headed into his studio, a small room with a wide mixing desk that faced a window through which I could see the recording booth. "Last night, this guy calls me, I don't know who, his voice was disguised somehow, and tells me that we're doing this prank on you - the fact he used the word 'we' means that he's one of Marcus' other friends, one of our group. Do you want to listen to our latest track? I just finished mastering it."

Brad could talk for hours. Especially when he'd smoked some weed like he clearly had been doing just now.

“I’d love to but I don’t have time. Maybe tomorrow. You could email me a link.”

“Cool. Anyway, where was I? Oh yeah, that was it.” He rested himself on the mixing desk and invited me to sit in the chair, which I did. “He told me I had to write you a letter and basically told me what to say in it, but I don’t do letters. I write music, baby. Not letters.”

I rolled my eyes. Brad wasn’t only hot, he was hilarious, even if it was unintentional at times. “So if you haven’t written me a letter, what am I doing here? Are you just going to give me the final code?”

“I haven’t written a letter because I’m just gonna say it instead.” He flexed his knuckles and loosened his impressive shoulders. He was wearing a black rock vest that showed off his toned physique along with his multitude of tattoos that covered both arms from wrist to shoulder. I’d never seen Brad with his shirt off but I was pretty sure that was covered in pretty tattoos too. He fixed his dark eyes on me - he was wearing eyeliner, he always wore eyeliner - and he stroked his short beard while considering his words carefully. Not for the first time, I was struck by his handsomeness. I didn’t usually go for rocker guys but Brad had that certain something about him. He almost reminded me of the Thor character from the movies.

“Whatever you’re going to say, just spit it out,” I said impatiently. “Trust me, it can’t be any more embarrassing than what Sam, Ryan and Leon had to say.”

“Well, if you’re sure.” The usually confident Brad fiddled with his leather and string wristbands for a second, then looked up at me. “I’ve wanted to fuck you for so long, Lacey. You drive me crazy with your red hair - I fucking love red hair - and your curvy ass. Damn, I’d love to rip

those pants off you right now, bend you over this mixing desk and fuck you to kingdom come.”

“Here we go again,” I sighed, actually feeling almost immune to the cringe now. “As fun as it is to hear, I’ve heard the same three times today. Can’t any of you be original?”

“Ha,” Brad’s face lit up in amusement and he grinned, making the edges of his eyes crinkle handsomely. “That’s the Lacey I know and love. You want originality? I am the creative one out of us, I guess.”

“Or, you could just give me the code and help me figure out what I’m supposed to do next,” I folded my arms across my chest defensively as he took a step in my direction, looming over me.

“The difference with me is that I’m not afraid to try it on with you,” Brad said, his eyes looking me up and down. I suddenly felt very small in front of him. Like the others, he was tall but his presence was more to do with his charisma and gravitas rather than sheer bulk.

“What do you mean?” I tried to act cool.

“The only reason I haven’t fucked you is because I respect Marcus too much. Be honest, Lacey Hawke. If I hit on you, you’d be tempted, wouldn’t you?”

“You’re very full of yourself, *Bradley Smith*.” I used his full name to try to slow him down - to try and knock his ‘rockstar’ ego down a peg, but it didn’t work.

“I could fuck you if I really wanted to. I’ve seen how you look at me, Lacey. When you and Marcus come to our concerts, your boyfriend might as well not be there. You stare at me the entire time, especially when I’m slamming the guitar. Tell me, honestly, how many times have you gone

home after one of your concerts and wished it was me fucking you rather than my cousin?”

I blinked and opened my mouth to retort but I had no words. He was right. I’d imagined fucking him while with Marcus dozens of times but I wasn’t going to admit to it.

“Marcus knows,” Brad continued. “I’ve told him loads of times and he says he knows. He thinks that you probably fantasize about all his buddies. We’re a good-looking bunch after all, most of us are younger, closer to your age than he is. He knows, Lacey. He thinks that’s why you won’t marry him. Because if you’re so attracted to his friends, that must mean that you don’t love him enough to marry him. Something like that, anyway.”

Those words hit me. Was that truly how Marcus felt? To be honest, he wasn’t entirely wrong. It wasn’t as simple as how Brad had just described it, but I did feel a longing inside me that Marcus couldn’t fill.

“He also tells me that you’ve got a cupboard full of sex toys at home; that you’re obsessed with them; always buying the latest one to try. Is that true? Are you trying to fill a void, Lacey?”

I wish he’d stop using my name. Every time he said it, I felt a tingle between my thighs. Shit. I was so fucking horny. I needed to leave. This didn’t feel right. I needed to get to Marcus.

“Brad, please, can you just give me the final code number and help me find your cousin?”

“You feel uncomfortable, right? Have I hit a few home truths?” Brad held out his hand for me to take, and he eased me from the chair to stand in front of him. His pretty brown eyes gazed into mine.

“M-m-maybe,” I stammered.

“Admit it, Lacey. If I bent you over like this-” Brad turned me around and pushed me over the mixing desk so that my face was staring into the booth through the thick glass. “If I took down your jeans.”

His hand curled around my hip and undid my jeans button. I should stop him. This wasn’t right. Marcus was waiting for me.

Brad didn’t take my jeans down. Instead, he slid his hand inside my panties.

“Should I stop?” he pushed my hair away from my neck and murmured softly into my ear, so close that I could feel the warmth of his lips. “Just say stop and I’ll stop, Lacey.”

Why wasn’t I saying ‘stop?’

His hand slid down, pushing over my mound and then I felt his fingers touch me, grazing over my clit. I felt a pang of shame because he must be able to feel how wet I already was.

“I thought so,” the rocker said, suddenly pulling his hand away, leaving me bent over the desk, breathing heavily. “It’s good to know that I could have you if I wanted to.”

“Brad!” I spun around, anger replacing my horniness for a moment. “How dare you tease me? If you’re such a stud, like you say you are, then fuck me. Right now. I admit it. I want you. Come on, if you’re man enough.”

“Oh, I’m man enough,” he laughed, and then his face softened. “I’m sorry. I didn’t mean to tease you. We have all the time in the world after this to finish what I just started - if you really want to, that is - but right now, you need my help finding Marcus. And I can help you. He told me what you have to do next.”

I fastened up the button of my jeans and pulled myself together. He was right. I'd lost control for a moment and felt embarrassed but this was the perfect opportunity to quickly move on before I gave in again.

"What's the code?" I asked.

"Three. The final number is three. Now you have to find the map. You know where it is, right?"

I shook my head. "No. I've not come across it yet."

"On the phone, the guy said you already have the map. You've had it since this morning. He says it came with a flower."

No fucking way. It had been under my nose this whole time. I dashed out of the studio, leaving a stunned Brad behind for a moment and pulling open the passenger side door of my car, I foraged around for the three gifts that Marcus had left me this morning. Or was it Marcus that had left them? He'd implied that someone had been in the house and hidden or stolen my phone. Could the stranger also have left the gifts or tampered with them?

I found the single red rose on the backseat, next to the sparkly-nosed teddy and passion fruit candle and slid what I had presumed to simply be a protective piece of paper from the stem and unfurled it.

It was a map. A crudely drawn map, but a map nonetheless.

"Do you have it?" Brad asked, coming outside to join me at the car.

"Got it," I nodded and pointed to the building circled red in the middle of the page. "Look."

"The Hotel Grande." The rocker nodded his approval. "Nice place. A bit of a drive from here though. You should get on your way."

"Will you come with me?" I asked on a whim, suddenly nervous of what might lie at the end of my quest. "And what does this mean?"

I noticed a line of handwritten text at the bottom of the map. It looked slightly like Marcus's handwriting but upon the second examination, it wasn't.

Would you do me

"I have no idea what that means other than what it suggests," Brad shrugged his beefy, tattooed shoulders. "Whoever he is, he wants to know if you'd fuck him."

"Is it you?" I asked, gazing into his eyes for a moment.

"No, it's not me," the long-haired singer replied, sounding sincere for a moment. "Besides, I know the answer to that question. Also, whoever it is, they missed off the question mark."

"Someone illiterate then," I joked. "The other guys said there was another riddle. That I had to use the heat of passion to work out the real truth. Does that mean anything to you?"

"No. I wish it did. And I wish I could come with you, but there's a meeting I have to be at. I'm sorry. I'm sure it'll be fine though. Whoever it is that's behind all this, I'm sure it's just a bit of fun. It'll all work out, Lacey. I'm sure of it."

"I wish I was," I exhaled, then turned to face Brad. "Can we pretend that what just happened in the studio never happened?"

"No," he grinned mischievously. "It happened. Live with it. Oh, and you'll need this."

He passed me a hotel keycard.

"You had this the whole time?" I asked incredulously.

"Yup."

“So why do I need the code?”

“I have no idea. I think you have to go find out.” Brad left me standing by the car and headed back into the studio. Was he the one behind all this? The fact that he had the hotel keycard and seemed to know about the map being the paper on the rose was just too much to ignore.

I got in the car. This was it. I was almost at the end. It was time to go save Marcus.

6

3.30 PM

The exterior of the Hotel Grande matched its name. It was the biggest hotel in the area, built almost fully from shining silver steel and dark glass and the glowing sign over the entrance was as high-tech as you got out here in the rural part of Derbyshire.

I parked outside and took the keycard out of my pocket. It had the room number - 23 - and so I quickly headed into the hotel, past a Harley Davidson just like the one I'd seen at Leon's garage, and once inside I located the elevator and rode to the second floor.

My nerves were shot. My heart was pounding in my chest in anticipation of what lay ahead of me but I didn't have any option other than to press ahead and find out.

I found the room and paused to gather myself before trying the keycard. Despite being nervous, I was also as horny as hell. The encounters with the four guys before this had left me soaking wet. I hoped Marcus was horny because once I'd found him, I was going to ride his cock all afternoon until it was time to go to the restaurant.

"Marcus?" I called through the door but there was no answer. I tried the keycard, sliding it through the reader and the little light above it turned green and I heard the door unlock.

Here we go.

I pushed the door open and saw why Marcus couldn't reply. He was tied to a chair in the centre of the room with a gag in his mouth.

"Oh, fuck," I said, dashing into the room without realising I might be in danger. I paused, looking around me but there didn't seem to be anyone else around. The shower room was empty. I checked in the large wardrobe at the far side of the spacious room. No one. The only person here was Marcus, tied to a chair next to the large, luxurious and very comfortable-looking bed.

"Marcus, what have they done to you?" I asked, checking him over but apart from being tied up, he seemed okay. "Let me untie you."

I pulled out the gag and he smiled at me, seeming surprisingly unflustered. "I think you need a code."

When I bent down behind him, I realised what the code was for. His hands were restrained by a metal strap which was fastened with a combination lock.

"Nine. Six. Five. Three." I said the numbers out loud as I turned the dials one by one. "There you go. That should work."

Marcus wriggled his hands and to my delight, the lock popped open and the restraints fell onto the red carpeted floor.

"Thank God for that," my boyfriend said, flexing his fingers and wrists. "I've been bound up like that all day."

"Are you okay?" As he stood up and stretched his back, I walked around to face him and looked him up and down once more, searching for any harm but he stopped me.

"I'm absolutely fine. It's just someone having some fun. I told you. We were never in any danger."

“A very intricate prank,” I nodded, then pulled him over to the bed. The sense of relief of this being over was too much and I felt hornier than ever. “Do I get a prize? I want a prize. I’m horny. Then we can work out who set all this up.”

“Lacey,” he chuckled. “That can wait. Tell me why you’re horny.”

What was I to tell him? I sat on the bed, looking my handsome boyfriend up and down. He was wearing a crisp white shirt and tie and a pair of dark trousers. He looked hot in his suit and office clothes. He always had. Marcus might not be as tall, or as broad, or as charming or as well-hung as his friends, but he was mine and I wanted him fiercely right then. I grabbed the belt at his waist but he stopped me, catching my wrist with his hand.

“Tell me what happened, Lacey,” he said in a soft voice. “Did you work out the clues? Remember, I’ve been here this whole time. You haven’t told me anything that happened. We can have sex in a while. I need to know what happened after our phone call this morning. Please?”

He sat next to me and I pushed my frustrations aside for a moment. He was right. He must have been worrying about me this entire time. I was being selfish. The issue was how much to tell him.

I gazed into my boyfriend’s dark blue eyes. He deserved the truth.

“Whoever set this prank up was cruel, if I’m honest,” I began. “The clues led me to Sam, then Ryan, Leon and finally Brad.”

I related the clues and how we’d worked them out, one by one and then I got to the subject of the letters.

“They all told me that they wanted me,” I said, feeling my cheeks grow hot again. “As in, they wanted sex with me. Kind of weird and very embarrassing.”

“Really fucking weird but it made you horny?” Marcus guessed.

God, this was difficult. I was about to admit that it had indeed made me horny, Marcus knew I fancied his friends, I hadn’t needed to hear that from Brad. He knew and I knew.

Then there was a knock at the door.

“Nearly the last part of the game,” Marcus said softly and pointed to the door. “The guy in the balaclava told me this would happen. You have to answer it.”

“Really?” My pulse was racing again but I was also disappointed that I wasn’t going to be able to fuck my boyfriend on this lovely big bed.

Marcus nodded and I walked over to the door and opened it with a trembling hand.

“Surprise,” said Sam but he wasn’t the only one standing outside. All four guys that I’d seen today stepped into the room as I invited them in.

“Are you okay?” Brad asked his cousin and Marcus nodded and gave him a thumbs up.

“What are you wearing?” Ryan became the second person to ask that question as he walked past me.

“I was going to ask that,” my boyfriend said, standing up to pass the five of us and stand by the hotel window.

“I loaned it to her at the garage,” Leon explained. “She got oil on her other top.”

“Did she now?” Marcus frowned at first his friend, then me. “Okay. I’ll let you explain that later, Lacey.”

“What’s going on?” I asked, quickly changing the subject. “Why are you all here?”

“The final part of the puzzle,” Marcus replied, gazing out of the window. Something felt strange. There was a final part?

“One of us in this room set up this prank,” my boyfriend said, turning around to face us. “Lacey, you have to figure out which who. You get one guess.”

“What do I win if I get it right?” I asked, trying to make light of what was a rather heavy mood that had settled over the room.

“I think you’ll find out once you’ve given us your guess.” Marcus looked at each of the four men standing next to me. “Before you ask, I don’t know what happens if you get it wrong either.”

“Give it your best shot,” Sam said, putting his large hand on my shoulder. “I’m telling you now, it’s not me.”

“Nor me,” Ryan folded his arms and looked suspiciously at the other men standing around.

“You know it’s not me,” Brad said quietly into my ear.

Leon shrugged. “I’ll be disappointed if you pick me,” he said softly. “If you want whatever the prize is, choose someone else. But it’s your call.”

And at that moment, I knew who it was.

“Leon,” I said, gazing at the black mechanic. “How long have you been here?”

He smiled. “I got here a little while before you,” he admitted. “I picked Brad up on his motorbike. Why?”

“Who told you to come?” I asked.

“Balaclava guy,” he shrugged. “He said Brad knew where to come and the room number. He said to wait for you, then give you a little while before coming to the room.”

“I believe you,” I said. It wasn’t Leon. It wasn’t Brad either. As Sam had said and as he’d proved in the studio, he was much more of a straightforward guy. This entire prank was way too long-winded for anything Brad might plan.

I looked at Sam and Ryan. “Does either of you have your phone?” They both nodded. “Could you call my phone?”

They looked at each other for a moment and then Sam pulled his phone from his pocket and called it.

“It’s not connecting,” he replied with a shrug.

“No matter,” I smiled. It didn’t matter. It would have been a fun way of uncovering the abductor but I’d find another way of dramatically revealing it.

“Who tied Marcus’s hands?” I asked the four of them. “One of you did.”

“You have to guess,” Ryan pointed out.

“I know who’s behind all of this,” I said, pacing around the room now, doing my best impersonation of Peter Falk’s Columbo character. “What I asked was who tied Marcus’s hands.”

“Explain,” my boyfriend said from behind me and I turned around to face him.

“Where’s my phone?” I asked, then continued when he shrugged as though he didn’t know. “Because no one broke into our house, Marcus. The doors were locked and none of them had been forced. The only explanation is that you took my phone. Tell me, who tied your hands?”

“Explain,” he repeated, a smile slowly growing on his lips.

“Because you can’t have called me this morning if your hands were tied. You said that the balaclava guy blindfolded you and locked you in but

when I got here just now, I can't see a blindfolded and you're not locked in. You're tied up. So you're the one that needs to explain, not me."

My boyfriend was watching me. Waiting for me to continue.

"You said you'd got something amazing planned for me. You weren't talking about the restaurant, you were talking about this game. You're all in on it, all five of you but you're behind all of this, aren't you? You're the mastermind, Marcus."

My boyfriend nodded. The golden light of the low, late afternoon sun illuminated his face as he walked over and took my hands. "Correct," he said softly, then kissed me.

I melted into his arms, my arousal surging back but I pushed him away.

"Why?" I looked around at his four friends who were watching us with wide smiles on their faces. "I don't understand."

Marcus took my hands in his and gazed at me, his face a mask of honesty.

"I know I'm not enough for you-"

"Marcus, stop," I interrupted him but he squeezed my hands to silence me.

"Let me finish," he said softly. "I love you deeply and I believe you love me too."

"I do-"

"Stop interrupting me," he implored. "Let me say what I have to say."

"I'm sorry."

"And don't apologise." Marcus took a deep breath before continuing. "I brought you here, I set this entire thing up, to help you understand that I know my shortcomings and I know your ambitions. I've talked to all four of my friends here about it and we came up with a plan. They didn't know all

the details. They weren't lying to you when they said they didn't know all the answers, so don't be cross with them. They were playing the game, all designed to bring you here, so I could tell you this: I understand. And it's cool. It's fine. I want you to be happy with me, Lacey. I want nothing more. Nothing."

"Marcus, I don't know what to say." I still didn't quite understand where this was going.

"You've got a drawer full of sex toys. You love sex. I can't keep up with you. You know that's true and it's cool. I know you fancy all of the guys in this room. I know you fantasize about them, not only when you're masturbating but also while you're in my arms; while we're making love. And it's cool. I know the reason you won't fully commit to me; why you're not completely fulfilled; is because you want more from your sex life. Just admit it, Lacey."

"Marcus, this really isn't the time and place for this conversation--"

"Oh, but it is. You asked if there was a prize for solving the game as there is. You win."

"I win... what?" I looked around the room, nonplussed at what he was saying.

"You won't settle down with me because deep down, you want to fuck other guys," Marcus said simply and bluntly. "So here is your chance. I've taken a long time to think about this and I'm okay with it. You have your choice, Lacey. All of the men in this room want to fuck you and you want to fuck them. I am the only reason that you haven't, so I am removing myself from being a reason. I'm giving you permission to have sex with whichever one of them you choose. Right here, in this hotel room."

No fucking way. I stared at my husband. "Are you being serious?"

“I’ve never been more serious in my entire life,” he replied without blinking.

“Is this some sort of test?”

“No,” Marcus shook his head. “I’ve talked it through with all the guys here. It’s cool. I promise. This is really happening, Lacey. Pick one of the guys. I want you to. I truly do. I’ll let you fuck whoever you want, then they’ll go home and we can talk about our future at the Purple Ivy tonight. I’m being genuine, Lacey. I want this for you.”

“Now we all kind of want you to pick us,” Brad smiled and the other three guys all laughed and then settled their eyes on me, waiting for my decision.

Marcus was being genuine. I’d been in love with him for ten years. I knew him better than anyone and he knew me too. If he said he was cool with this, then I believed him. It was a dream come true, in a way, even though it felt weird. And I was unbelievably horny by this point.

Fuck it. I was going to do this but who was I to choose? All four guys were hot as hell.

There was only one answer I could possibly give.

“I choose all of them.”

“What?” Now it was time for Marcus to be caught off guard.

“All of them,” I shrugged, turning the tables on him. “I can’t settle on one. I want to fuck them all.”

4.25 PM

“**Y**ou want to fuck all of them?” Marcus parroted, blinking rapidly and gazing out of the window at the sun which was hanging low down over the lush, green horizon outside.

“One at a time, or...?” Sam asked, so I turned to face him,

“How would you prefer it?” I countered coolly.

“So be it,” Marcus announced, turning back to face us. He grinned, despite the tension hanging in the air. “If this is what it takes, then so be it. Lacey, this is my Valentine’s gift to you. Guys? Fill your boots.”

Then it began and everything happened quickly.

“First of all, I need my shirt back,” announced Leon and before anyone else could move, he stepped forward and taking the hem of the t-shirt, he lifted it up and over my head, exposing my bra and breasts to everyone.

“I need to finish what I started,” Brad said next, approaching and undoing the button on my jeans again. This time, he didn’t slide a hand down my panties. Instead, he tugged them down along with my panties so that now I was standing in my bra alone.

“Wow,” breathed Ryan, his eyes sweeping up and down the full length of me. “I’ve wanted to see you naked for so long. Your body is everything I’d imagined it to be.”

Sam was behind me, unclasping my bra and as he let it drop to the floor, I looked over at Marcus. His girlfriend of ten years was completely naked in front of his four best friends. How must he feel?

“Are you sure you’re okay with this?” I asked softly. “Wouldn’t you rather wait outside or something?”

“No,” he shook his head. “I thought I might need to, but I don’t.”

“So you’re going to join in?” I moaned as someone’s fingers touched my clit. Someone else’s hands were on my breasts but my attention was all on Marcus. I loved him and I needed to make sure he was okay.

“I’m just going to watch,” he said, pulling over the chair that he’d been bound to earlier and sitting on it. “I want to save it for later. After the restaurant.”

“Oh, fuck,” I groaned. This was too much. The thought that Marcus was going to watch his friends have sex with me was insanely exciting. I closed my eyes and felt someone lift me and carry me to the bed. I was almost delirious with arousal. I needed someone’s dick in me. I needed it right now.

I opened my eyes and discovered that it was Ryan that had carried me. His arms were strong and I clutched onto him as he lowered me onto the crisp cotton sheets.

“I need you,” I said, throatily. “Someone just fuck me already.”

Ryan stripped off his shirt to reveal a pleasantly smooth chest and I saw that the other three were likewise undressing. Sam’s huge cock was even bigger now it was erect and it loomed over my face as he climbed onto the bed. I couldn’t help but grab it and guided it into my mouth as the others joined him alongside me, their hands eager to touch me.

His precum tasted almost sweet as it leaked from the throbbing head of his dick and I sucked it hungrily, lustily, the biggest penis I'd sucked since college, over ten years ago.

"Fuck me, Marcus wasn't lying when he said she was a nympho," I heard Leon say but I didn't comment. I was enjoying the feeling of Sam's thick shaft in my mouth too much.

Someone's fingers were inside me, two or three, I didn't know how many but they were working my hole fast and rough, just how I liked it. I knew I wasn't going to take long to orgasm, so I closed my eyes again and concentrated on sucking Sam. Whatever happened would happen. I was just going to enjoy it.

I sucked Leon's cock next, enjoying looking at it for a moment before taking it in my mouth after Sam moved away to let him have a turn. My first black cock was an inch longer than Sam's and slightly thicker. It was an even darker brown than the rest of him and curved upwards threateningly as he rubbed it against my cheek.

I looked down for a moment to see Ryan's cock. He was kneeling on the bed, stroking himself slowly while enjoying the sight of me naked before him. I spread my thighs wider, letting him enjoy the sight of the tidy triangle of reddish pubes atop my mound and then I wiggled my hips at him. "Fuck me, Ryan," I invited him, then took Leon in my mouth.

Ryan didn't hesitate. He positioned himself over me as I began to suck his black friend and I felt the head of his dick - not as big as Sam or Leon but still larger than Marcus - press against me.

"Don't tease me," I begged him around a mouthful of Leon's prick. "Just fuck me."

He pushed it in and the moment he entered me, I knew it was going to happen. It took just two thrusts and I orgasmed.

“She’s cumming,” Brad observed from somewhere to the side of me. I wanted his dick next.

“Already,” Ryan added. “Wow.”

Then he settled his position between my legs and fucked me so hard that it was difficult to concentrate on giving Leon a good blowjob but I tried.

“This is fucking crazy, man,” Brad said and I turned to see him mount the bed. I let go of Leon’s cock while Ryan continued to fuck me and took hold of the rocker’s sexy-looking dick, pulling it towards my face.

“I want you to fuck me next,” I said, admiring his average-sized but nicely girthy dick. Unlike the other guys, Brad’s was more natural, and hairier, but that was a turn-on for some reason as was his almost entirely-tattooed body in general. Brad was kind of rough and I liked that.

“I’m gonna fucking cum,” Ryan said, probably the first time I’d ever heard the usually suited and booted professional swear. He pulled his cock out and I looked down to see a string of sperm shoot from the tip of it, landing across my lower belly before he caught the rest in his hand. “Fuck, that was so good.”

I looked at Marcus. He was still sitting in his chair but now he’d got his trousers undone and his dick was in his hand. He’d just watched me get fucked by a new cock for the first time in ten years and he was jerking off to it?

Brad replaced Marcus, shoving his rockstar dick into me roughly and the girth of him caught me surprise, stretching me almost painfully as he pushed it in.

“Woah,” I told him softly. “Slow down.”

“Wait until you try to fit Sam’s and Leon’s cock inside you,” Marcus’s cousin grinned at me as he lowered his weight onto me. “You’re so fucking tight, Lacey.”

“That’s because she’s only had Marcus’s pencil dick inside her for the past decade,” Leon joked and I looked over Brad’s shoulder quickly to see how Marcus would react to the insult but my boyfriend only laughed.

“My dick has been the brunt of jokes for a few years now,” he explained, registering the look of concern on my face. “I told you. It’s all cool. Just have fun.”

So I did, I wrapped my legs around Brad and took his cock all the way inside me, enjoying the sensation of being stretched out and then as he began to thrust in and out, I closed my eyes again, enjoying the sensation of being fucked by a new man.

“Someone put a dick in her mouth,” Brad’s cousin suggested and a moment later, I felt the head of someone pushing against my lips. I opened my mouth without opening my eyes and accepted it greedily - it was Leon’s, I realised, from the curve of it. Then I felt Sam’s large hands grab mine and wrap them around his dick to jerk him off. I was pleasuring three men at the same time. The thought of that started to make my clit throb and I reached down with my free hand to play with myself while Brad pounded me.

I was in heaven. The guys enjoyed me like that for a little while until Brad’s thrusts became erratic and I felt his semen join Ryan’s on my belly. Then someone - I didn’t know who - flipped me onto my front and pulled my ass upwards.

“Who?” I began to ask until I saw Sam’s muscular thighs when I looked down underneath me. He positioned himself behind me and I braced myself

for the biggest penis yet but by now, I was so wet that he didn't have any problems entering me.

The feeling of a cock pushing quite so deep inside me was new, however, and I grunted in a mixture of pleasure and pain as he thrust inside smoothly, the end of him touching places inside me that only my larger vibrators had ever gone before.

"Oh, my god," Sam moaned. "Her pussy is like fucking heaven." Then he leaned over me, cupping my breasts with his hands from behind for a moment, and then started to fuck me.

"Fuck," I moaned, in rapture at the exquisite feeling of him probing me so deeply. "I wish I'd done this years ago. I could have been having these big cocks all this time."

I orgasmed again, this time even stronger than the one before. My back arched as the wave of heat rushed through me and moaned so loud that I heard Marcus say, "Holy shit," from the chair where he was still sitting and jerking off.

Sam's strong hands held me firmly and he kept fucking me right through the orgasm, which only served to heighten the pleasure, so much so that by the time he came all across my lower back and Leon replaced him to become the last guy to fuck me, I was still riding on the edge.

"Your first black cock," he said in his deep, sexy voice and then before I had any time to think about it, he shoved himself into me.

Holy fuck. If Sam was big, then Leon was huge. His long black dick seemed to go on forever, stretching me as much as Brad's did and pushing further inside than Sam had. By the time he was impaled fully inside me, I felt so full that I suddenly understood the meaning of the phrase 'being split in two.'

This was a real cock. This was what I needed. Simply from Leon being inside me; from being utterly filled up like this, I orgasmed again. I'd been on the edge still from Sam so forcefully manhandling me with his strength, but the feeling of Leon's cock sent me over the edge and back into the abyss of arousal.

When I'd finished shuddering from pleasure, he began to fuck me expertly, holding my hips as Sam had done, and slowly but firmly taking me deep with every stroke, building me towards what had to be my final climax.

I looked across the room to see Marcus watching me intently. His black trousers were still undone but his dick was limp in his hand now and splashes of cum were all over his thigh. He'd made himself cum.

The fact that he'd done that; that he'd watched me get gangbanged by four of his buddies and that he'd obviously enjoyed it, turned out to be the final straw for my poor pussy. I orgasmed again, this time so powerful that I squeezed Leon out of me and I collapsed onto the bed, my thigh muscles quivering manically.

"Give me a minute," I breathed as Leon lay next to me on the bed but he wasn't listening. Instead, he pushed my legs open and shoved himself into me roughly.

"Marcus says I can finish inside," the mechanic informed me softly into my ear and then he fucked me so hard that I almost passed out. I was in a state of pure pleasurable delirium as he took me masterfully until finally his cock stiffened inside me and then I felt the warmth of his cum fill me up.

Sometime later, I didn't know how long, I woke up in Marcus's arms. I was still naked, and I reached down to pull the sheet over us both. The four

other guys had gone. I must have drifted off into an exhausted but satisfied sleep right after Leon had finished fucking me.

“Marcus,” I whispered into his ear. “How long have I been asleep?”

My boyfriend opened his dark blue eyes and smiled after looking at the watch on his wrist. “Not long. Don’t worry. We’ll make the restaurant on time.”

“I can’t believe what just happened.” I was still whispering. My pussy was tingling pleasantly still and I could feel Leon’s seed inside me. “Are you okay?”

“I should be asking you that question,” Marcus chuckled. “The way they fucked you. I didn’t expect you to have all of them like that.”

“It serves you right,” I giggled, burying myself deeper into his arms and then kissing him softly on the lips. “Are you okay though? Are we okay?”

“We’re better than ever,” he said, pushing my hair out of my eyes and gazing lovingly at me. “I love you, Lacey Hawke. More than ever before. We can talk at the Purple Ivy. Are you ready to go home and get ready?”

I suddenly realised I was ravenous and my stomach growled at the thought of food. “My belly says yes,” I laughed.

“Then let’s go,” he said, sliding from the bed before looking down at his cum-stained trousers. “Once we’ve both cleaned up.”

8

8.10 PM

The meal had been wonderful. While we were getting dressed; Marcus in his best black suit and myself in my favourite emerald dress (it sets off my hair just right), I wondered if the sexual adventure we'd been on might affect our relationship. Marcus was quiet as if he had a lot on his mind and I probably was too. I had a lot to think about, and not just the fact that I'd just slept with his four best friends.

Everything he'd said about my reluctance to properly settle down and commit to a future together was right. Now that I'd enjoyed sex with someone else, I knew he was right. I'd been immediately satisfied earlier, but the longer the day went on and the more I thought about it, I realised that this afternoon couldn't be the last time I had sex with them.

I wasn't thinking about another group sex session. I wanted them on their own. All four of them. I couldn't help but wonder, even as we drove to the restaurant and ordered our starters, what each of his friends would be like on their own; what they'd be like to fuck one-on-one, and then to curl up in their arms and sleep all night with.

Marcus's quietness stopped when we got to the restaurant. We made idle conversation at first. He seemed happy and almost back to his normal self but there was... something. We needed to talk about what had happened today and everything that had been said but it wasn't until we were done

with our main course that he finally reached across the table and took my hand.

“Lacey,” he said softly, looking around before speaking further. “Obviously, we need to discuss earlier.”

“I know,” I said gently. “I love you but if you’re feeling differently about me now, then I understand. Now you know the real me. I’m a slut, aren’t I? You always called me your little nympho but what you want to call me now is a slut. Just say it. I’ll be fine. Just say what you want to say.”

I hadn’t meant to blurt out the slut comment but it had been on my mind and the words just flowed from my mouth before I had a chance to stop them.

Marcus frowned at me then shook his head slowly. “That’s not what I wanted to say. Not at all. Did you bring the Valentine’s gifts with you, as I told you to?”

“Yes,” I said, still concerned about what was going to happen next.

“Get them out for me.”

I reached into my bag and brought out the bear, candle and rose and passed them to him. He’d also told me to bring the map, so I handed him that too. He wanted the gifts back and that made me sad.

“You’re going to end it, aren’t you? It’s probably for the best. You can get someone better than me. Someone who you can make happy without having to worry about your friends fucking them.”

“Lacey, shut up,” Marcus rolled his eyes. “And listen. There’s one more riddle for you to solve. Do you remember it?”

I was too full of anxiety to remember at first. I was about to be publicly dumped in the best restaurant I’d ever been to.

“Lacey?” Marcus put a finger below my downcast chin and tilted it upwards to face him. “Do you remember?”

It came to me. “Something about embracing the heat of passion to get to the truth,” I mumbled disconsolately.

“And you haven’t figured it out yet?”

I looked at the items on the table between our two empty plates.

Oh.

The heat of passion. The candle was scented with passion fruit. Heat.

“The map has an unfinished message,” Marcus said, pointing to the words written at the bottom. The message was unfinished. There was no question mark, as one of the guys had noted earlier.

It couldn’t be, could it? I lit the passion fruit candle from the flickering candle in the centre of our table and then placed it down. Next, I took the map and gently held it over the flame, not too close for it to catch fire, but close enough for the heat from it to reveal the hidden extra words at the end of the message, written in secret marker, or possibly lemon juice. That was an old trick that I’d learned from reading so many detective novels.

“I’ve read a few of your books too,” Marcus grinned as he watched me work it out.

I read the message and gasped.

Now it read:

Would you do me - the honour of being my wife?

When I looked up, Marcus was holding the bear.

“Do you see his nose?” he asked. “Didn’t you wonder why it sparkled so brightly?”

He walked around the table and got on one knee next to me. Several of the other restaurant patrons stopped eating to watch. Some even stood up.

Marcus pulled at the bear's nose and the fabric opened up to reveal a golden band beneath. The diamond was real. And huge. It was beautiful.

"Marry me, Lacey."

"We've talked about this," I said in a hushed tone so that none of the bystanders could hear. "I can't until--"

"I will let you fuck any and all my friends whenever you want," he whispered. "Whatever conditions you set, I'll agree. I love you, Lacey. I want you with me always. No matter what we have to do to make you happy. This is the last time I'll ever ask you. Please, say yes. "

Would he really let me sleep with his friends? That would be quite something, if true. I looked at him, down on one knee, the glistening diamond in his outstretched hand. Of course it was true. This was Marcus. I knew him better than anyone and he knew me too. This man loved me and I loved him back. I truly, honestly did and what was more important than love?

"Yes," I said and a flood of happiness seemed to course through my veins as I said the word. This was right. It felt right. For the first time, it felt right.

The look of sheer joy on his face brought a tear to my eye and after he'd slipped the gorgeous ring onto the third finger of my left hand and the bystanders finished clapping, he took his seat again opposite me.

"You've just made me the happiest man on Earth," he said, wiping some dampness away from the corners of his eyes.

"We're engaged," I nodded, as happy for him - and us - as I'd ever been. "I can't believe it."

“Me neither.”

“I do have conditions, though.” It was my turn to look around to make sure no one was within earshot.

“I meant what I said,” he whispered. “If you having sex with other men is what it takes for you to be fulfilled and happy, then I’m cool with it. I can handle an open relationship, I think.”

“Well, that’s one of the conditions,” I nodded. This was going to be fun. “But there’s something else I want.”

“Name it.”

“I want to set up that business we talked about.”

“Ah,” Marcus closed his eyes. “That.”

“There’s an empty shop building next to Brad’s studio. We have enough money to start it up. The business is doing well, you keep saying.”

“Okay, fine.” Marcus puffed out his cheeks. “Just don’t tell my family what you’re selling.”

“Really?” I let out a little squeal of happiness. “You’ll let me open my own little lingerie and sex toy shop?”

Marcus nodded. “You probably own enough vibrators to stock it already.”

“Shut up,” I laughed back, and then I looked up, picturing it already. “Lacey’s Adult Emporium,” I envisioned out loud.

“That sounds like a brothel,” my boyfriend - no, fiancé - replied.

“Well, whatever, we can think of a name we both like.”

“And we will,” Marcus signalled over to the waiter and requested more wine. “As long as you’re not wanting to set up as a private investigator or something, I guess I can live with it.”

“A private investigator,” I mused. “Now what would I call that business if I owned it? The Sinful Sleuth, perhaps? The Deviant Detective? How about Improper Investigations?”

“Now that one, I like,” he laughed as the waiter brought over a fresh bottle of Chianti.

“Would you like a dessert?” the bald man asked after pouring some into a glass for Marcus to test.

“Do you do... cream pie?” Marcus asked with a totally straight face.

“You can’t say that?” I hissed at him after we’d both ordered a real dessert and the waiter was gone. Was he truly okay with me fucking his friends this afternoon? He must be, to make such a joke.

“I can and I did,” my fiance grinned sweetly. “Lacey, I don’t know what the future holds for us and how wild and weird or sordid it’s going to be, but I will tell you one thing.”

“Which is?”

“As long as I’m with you, I can’t wait to find out.”

I looked at the brilliant rock on my finger. Neither could I.

Afterword

I hope you enjoyed Lacey and Marcus's first adventure together. Yes, I said first. You'll soon get to meet them again in the first Improper Investigations book, coming very soon.

I know this book was told entirely from Lacey's point of view, a first for me as I've never published an entirely female POV before but fear not, fans of my more male-oriented stories, because the Improper Investigations books will be told through both Marcus's AND Lacey's eyes from here on out. There might also be some other surprise guest POVs too and there will be a lot more sex in the proper books than there was in this set-up story. You'll have to read and find out, once the first book goes live, hopefully sometime in late February or March.

Until then, be sure to try out the rest of the Ultimate Hotwife Valentine books, of which this is the second in a 22-book set, each written by a different author from the hotwife erotica niche. I'll put details of the next book in the series at the end of the book.

What's Next?

Which hotwife has the next sexy Valentine's adventure?

A Hotwife's Retreat by Reba Bale

This Valentine's Day, Dan is going to give his wife the ultimate gift — permission to sleep with as many men as she wants to over the course of one long weekend. There's only one rule: he gets to pick them out.

Last summer their anniversary trip took an unexpected turn when Sarah's husband shared her with a passing hiker. The interlude reinvigorated their relationship and showed them that bringing a third person into their relationship was something they both desired.

Dan is a powerful CEO, but despite all his billions of dollars, nothing makes him feel more powerful than sharing his young, beautiful wife with other men. He loves the feeling of control over the men, and his wife too.

Most of all, he loves taking his pleasure in Sarah after she's been with someone else, claiming her and reminding her who she belongs to.

Nothing makes Sarah feel more desirable than when her husband shares her. But will her husband really be okay with so much sharing in one weekend? She hopes so, because this hotwife retreat idea has her feeling hot, needy, and ready to see exactly how much she can take.

“A Hotwife’s Retreat” is fast and fun story of wife sharing, voyeurism, and sexy vacation adventures. This book is part of the Ultimate Hotwife Valentine series.

Ultimate Hotwife Valentine: Sometimes it takes more than two to tango. This multi-author series explores the lives of women who fulfill their

dirtiest fantasies with more than just their husband. Get in the mood and fall head over heels with these naughty hotwives and the men who love them.

Get Reba's book [HERE](#)

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ULTIMATE HOTWIFE VALENTINE

Sometimes it takes more than two to tango.

This multi-author series explores the lives of women who fulfill their dirtiest fantasies with more than just their husband.

Get in the mood and fall head over heels with these naughty hotwives and the men who love them:

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Book 4 – [My Hotwife's Loving Surprise](#) by GK Grayson Book 5 – [A Hot Wife Meets Cupid](#) by Natalie Hothorne Book 6 – [The Hotwife's First Proxy](#) by Sean Geist Book 7 – [A Hotwife's Special Night](#) by Olivia Lawless Book 8 – [A Hotwife's Adventure](#) by Kyle Canon Book 9 – [A Hotwife in Need](#) by Hardison Parker Book 10 – [A Hotwife Date Night](#) by Dilana Rose Book 11 – [A Hotwife Affair](#) by Daizy Dennis

Book 12 – [A Hotwife Shows Off](#) by Anya Knightly Book 13 – [A Hotwife Pampered](#) by Lola Blackburn Book 14 – [A Hotwife Learns the Ropes](#) by Alexa Sommers Book 15 – [A Hotwife's 2 for 1 Weekend](#) by Delores Swallows Book 16 – [A Hotwife Soccer Mom](#) by Hank Dolworth Book 17 – [The Hotwife's Blind Date](#) by Zoey Adams Book 18 – [A Hotwife Treat](#) by Devon Haze

Book 19 – [A Hotwife At The Club](#) by Cyra Wilde Book 20 - [A Hotwife's Valentine Present](#) by Jordan Riley Book 21 – [A Hotwife's Second Chance](#) by Kevin Jaxon Book 22 – [A Hotwife Valentine's](#) by Aila Glass

Also By Paul Garland

The Holiday Hotwives Series:

[Tina: Taking One For The Team](#)

[Kelly: Takes Two To Tango](#)

[Stacy: Three's A Crowd](#)

[A Hotwife's Christmas Roast](#)

A Size Queen Story Series:

[Part 1: Great Lengths](#)

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PAUL GARLAND

About the Author

Paul Garland is an author of erotic novels and short stories, guaranteed to keep you turning the lust-filled pages until the early hours of the night. He lives with his wife and two children in a small house in the suburbs of Sheffield, England along with a lazy green budgerigar, an African Grey parrot that curses and a tubby tabby cat which would love to eat either. (Preferably the vulgar-tongued parrot.)

He has been writing since the turn of the millennium but only turned to the erotica genre in 2018 with his *Cerulean Erotica Presents* series and *No Angels* series of books which rapidly gained him a following. In 2020, he began '*The Cuckold Collection*,' a brand new collection of cuckold-themed books and two new series of shorter stories: *The No Angels Stories*, *The Sexy Season Stories* and *The Cerulean Archives*. 2022 began two series,

Holiday Hotwives and *A Size Queen Story* and 2023 will introduce a new series, *Improper Investigations*.

You can connect with me on:



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